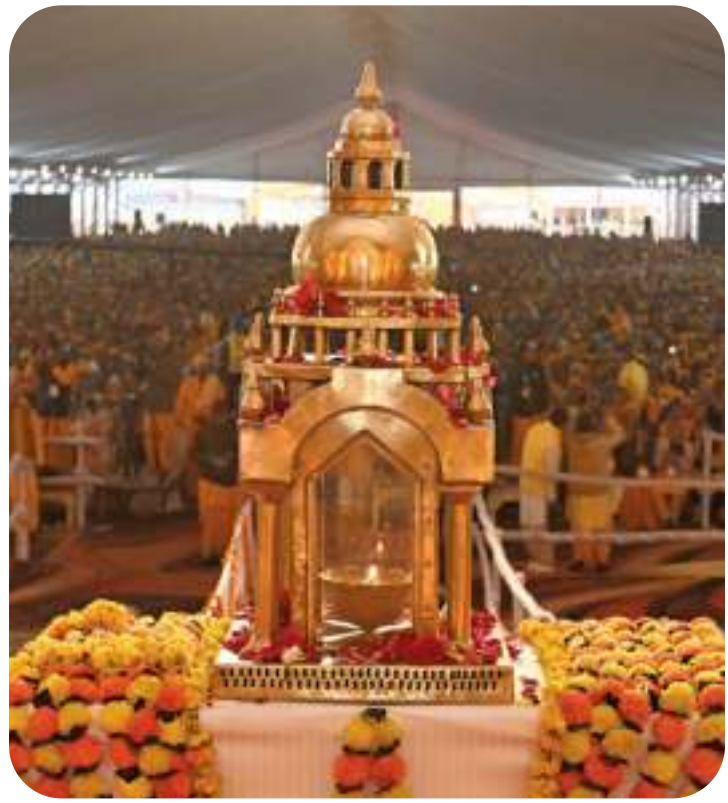





Avdheshanand Giri, head of the Juna Akhara, and members of the House of Lords in the United Kingdom—Lord Krish Raval and Lord Mendelson. Addressing the gathering, Dr. Chinmay Pandya emphasised that education is not merely about acquiring knowledge but about nurturing and elevating human consciousness. He urged students to embrace their responsibilities toward society. On the same day, a tribal convention was organised at the centenary venue. Representatives from tribal communities of Jharkhand, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, and Madhya Pradesh presented traditional folk dances, creating a vibrant spectacle that beautifully reflected India's cultural diversity and enduring unity.

A collective commitment to environmental care

On 20 January, the Jyoti Kalash Yatra was organised, filling the environment with devotion and spiritual fervour. Jyoti Kalash processions that had arrived not only from across India but also from many countries around the world were ceremonially worshipped with Vedic chants and rituals. As the procession moved forward amid a shower of flowers, it symbolised a powerful message—that the flame of spiritual awareness transcends borders and illuminates humanity at large. The procession was led in the presence of Shaildidi, Swami Harichetananand Ji Maharaj, Dr. Chinmay Pandya, and other revered saints. Accompanied by devotional songs and floral offerings, the entire atmosphere resonated with spiritual vibrancy. On 21 January, the "Environmental and Atmospheric Purification Pledge Ceremony" connected the centenary celebrations with pressing social responsibilities. The programme was attended by Yoga Guru Swami Ramdev, Swami Avdheshanand Giri of the Juna Akhara, senior RSS functionary Gopal Arya, and Union Minister of State for Tribal Affairs Durga Prasad Uikey, among other dignitaries. On this occasion, Dr. Chinmay Pandya administered a pledge to thousands of volunteers, committing that in every district of the country a campaign would be launched to cleanse and protect one river, one pilgrimage site, and one pond, along with the plantation of thousands of trees.

The grandeur of the centenary celebrations reached another milestone on 22 January, when Union Home Minister Amit Shah visited Shantikunj. He offered his respects to the century-old Akhand Deep and met Dr. Pranav Pandya and Shaildidi. During his visit, he acknowledged the Gayatri Parivar's significant contribution to social reform and moral awakening.

The dawn of a new era

On the eve of Basant Utsav, the Deep Mahayajna became the most divine and dazzling moment of the centenary celebrations. Illuminated by millions of lamps, Bairagi Dweep appeared like a radiant ocean of light. When Shaildidi arrived carrying the sacred flame from the century-old Akhand Deep, and from that flame two and a half lakh lamps were lit, the moment turned profoundly emotional and spiritually uplifting.

On this occasion, Swami Govinddev Giri, Treasurer of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, attended as the chief guest, while Defence Minister Rajnath Singh addressed the gathering virtually.

On 23 January, the sacred occasion of Basant Panchami witnessed thousands of spiritual aspirants receiving initiation into the Gayatri Mahamantra. Shaildidi bestowed the initiation as the representative of the revered Guru tradition, while Dr. Pranav Pandya elaborated on the significance and discipline of Guru Diksha.

On the same day, Dr. Chinmay Pandya arrived at Bairagi Dweep carrying the century-lit Akhand Deep and the sacred Charan Paduka. Amid thunderous chants and showers of flowers from thousands of devotees, the scene became deeply moving and spiritually charged.

On 24 January, the centenary celebrations concluded with the Matri Samarpan Yatra and the closing ceremony. The event was attended by Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Uttarakhand Governor Lieutenant General Gurmeet Singh, Dr. Chinmay Pandya, and many other saints and dignitaries.

Jyoti Kalash processions that had travelled across around 80 countries returned to their spiritual home at Shantikunj. The conclusion of the celebration was not merely the end of an event—it was the clarion call of a new era, carrying forward a collective resolve that thousands of seekers would now take back to their respective regions.

The centenary spiritual congregation at Shantikunj concluded with a deep conviction—that the flame of consciousness ignited by the Yugrishi will continue to illuminate humanity for centuries to come. This flame does not burn in Shantikunj alone; it shines in the hearts of the millions who, through this celebration, pledged themselves to the creation of a new age of awakening.

And perhaps that is the greatest achievement of the centenary celebration—a spiritual movement that transcends the limits of time and guides humanity toward a brighter future.